configurations defined in the template. For example, `new_cars`, `sports_cars`, and `vintage_cars` indexes have `created_by` and `created_at` properties, as well as shards and replicas 1 and 3, respectively, if these are defined in the template.

Listing 6.32 Creating an index template

```
PUT _index_template/cars_template
{
  "index_patterns": ["*cars*"],
  "priority": 1,
  "template": {
    "mappings": {
      "properties":{
        "created_at":{
          "type":"date"
        },
        "created_by":{
          "type":"text"
        }
      }
    }
  }
}
```

When we execute this command (you may get a deprecation warning—ignore it for now), the template is created with the index pattern `*cars*`. When we create a new index, if the name of the new index (say, `vintage_cars`) matches the pattern (`*cars*`), the index is created with the configuration defined in the template. When the index matches the given pattern, the templated configurations are applied automatically.

Template priority

An index template carries a priority: a positive number defined when creating the template. The higher the priority, the higher the precedence. Priority is useful when we have similar or the same settings in two different templates. If an index matches more than one index template, the one with higher priority is used. For example, `cars_template_feb21` overrides `cars_template_mar21` in the following code (although the names suggest the other way around!):

```
POST _index_template/cars_template_mar21
{
  "index_patterns": ["*cars*"],
  "priority": 20,
  "template": { ... }
}
POST _index_template/cars_template_feb21
{
  "index_patterns": ["*cars*"],
```

Lower-priority index template